

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst, Defensive Operations | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | MITRE ATT&CK | Threat Hunting

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security analyst specialising in defensive operations, with over five years of experience protecting enterprise environments through advanced threat detection, incident response, and threat hunting. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)), Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR). I am proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection rule development and threat investigation, and I apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework to gap analysis, detection coverage mapping, and proactive threat hunting. I have led incident response activities across the full lifecycle - detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned - and developed Incident Response (IR) playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61. I am driven to contribute to a defensive operations function where technical tooling, detection engineering, and cross-team collaboration are central to protecting the organisation from evolving threats.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection rule development, alert tuning, log source onboarding, false-positive reduction
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Incident Response (IR):** Full IR lifecycle management aligned to NIST 800-61 - detection, analysis, root cause analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; IR playbook development and maintenance
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive threat hunts based on threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and incident learnings; converting hunt findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations
- **MITRE ATT&CK Framework:** Detection coverage mapping, adversary simulation gap analysis, technique-based hunt development
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** PowerShell-based automation and playbook development; Microsoft Sentinel automation rules and Logic Apps integration
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Network Security:** IDS/IPS monitoring, firewall rule analysis, Check Point Harmony, Mimecast email security gateway
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Certifications:** Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Lead defensive security operations across the enterprise, operating Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM and developing KQL-based detection rules to identify novel attack patterns and improve detection coverage aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques.

- Conduct advanced investigations of escalated security incidents, performing root cause analysis, evidence gathering, and determining containment and eradication strategies across Microsoft Defender XDR and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR.
- Lead incident response activities through the full lifecycle - detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned - in accordance with NIST 800-61, producing detailed post-incident reports and feeding findings back into detection improvement.
- Develop and execute threat hunting programmes based on threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and findings from previous incidents, converting hunt outcomes into actionable detection rules or SIEM tuning recommendations.
- Maintain and configure the technical security tooling stack including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender XDR, overseeing log source onboarding, health monitoring, and detection performance.
- Develop and maintain incident response playbooks and runbooks to standardise analyst response procedures across common attack scenarios and improve mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) to minimise the risk of identity-based attacks and lateral movement.
- Automate security operations workflows using PowerShell scripting and Microsoft Sentinel automation rules, reducing manual analyst workload and accelerating response to high-frequency alert types.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, configuring attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, automated investigation and response (AIR), and custom detection policies aligned to the organisation's threat model.
- Operated Microsoft Sentinel daily, writing KQL queries to investigate security events, build correlation rules, and create workbooks for threat visibility across endpoint, identity, email, and network log sources.
- Monitored CrowdStrike Falcon EDR for endpoint threats, triaging detections, escalating confirmed incidents, and carrying out initial containment actions including host isolation and process termination.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting activities using endpoint telemetry, SIEM queries, and threat intelligence feeds to identify indicators of compromise and low-and-slow attack activity not surfaced by automated alerts.
- Investigated Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) alerts to identify Active Directory-based threats including credential theft, Pass-the-Hash, and lateral movement attempts.
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway, investigating email-borne threats and tuning policies to prevent phishing, malware delivery, and business email compromise at the perimeter.
- Led vulnerability management using Nessus, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, prioritising findings using a risk-based approach and tracking remediation through to closure with asset owners.
- Contributed to the development of incident response playbooks and security standard operating procedures, standardising analyst response for common attack types including ransomware, phishing, and account takeover.
- Conducted regular MITRE ATT&CK framework reviews to identify gaps in detection coverage and drive detection engineering improvements in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ and ISO 27001 security programme activities, contributing to audit preparation, control evidence gathering, and policy review.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and managed security controls across cloud and SaaS infrastructure, configuring endpoint security, identity access management, and network security tooling.
- Monitored security alerts and conducted initial triage and investigation of suspicious activity, escalating confirmed incidents for senior review and remediation.
- Managed Microsoft 365 security configuration including identity policies, Conditional Access, and MFA rollout across the organisation.

- Supported vulnerability scanning and patch management activities, maintaining up-to-date asset inventory and remediating critical and high-severity vulnerabilities within agreed SLAs.
- Contributed to quality assurance reviews of security configurations, identifying gaps against industry best practices and producing risk-based improvement recommendations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to 8,000 users at UAL, establishing comprehensive endpoint visibility and automated threat containment capability across a complex, multi-site estate.
- Reduced SIEM false-positive rates significantly by developing and refining KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, allowing analysts to focus investigation effort on high-fidelity alerts.
- Led multiple incident response engagements through the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle, including containment of advanced phishing campaigns and endpoint compromise incidents, producing lessons-learned reports that drove detection improvements.
- Developed a structured threat hunting programme at UAL using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, resulting in the identification of previously undetected attacker persistence mechanisms and the creation of new detection rules.
- Designed and implemented PowerShell-based SOAR automation workflows for common alert types in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) on high-frequency incidents.
- Operationalised BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control and audit privileged access across the estate, eliminating unmanaged administrator accounts and providing full session recording for compliance purposes.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)